

software packages, their updates and also provides the controls to administrators to manually update a few packages if they want to. It has a roll-back feature in case an update causes any malfunction in a machine. CoreUpdate can manage multiple systems at a time.

CoreOS was designed to promote the use of open source OS kernel, which is used in a lot of cloud based virtual servers. The CoreOS consumes less than half of instance as compared to other Linux distribution services.

Applications of distributions run in a virtualised container called Docker. They can start instantly. CoreOS was launched in December last year. It uses two partitions, which help in easily updating distributions. One partition contains the current OS, while the other is used to store the updated OS. This smoothen out the entire process of upgrading a package or an entire distribution. The service can be directly installed and run in the system or via cloud services like Amazon, Google or Rackspace. The venture capital firm, Kleiner Perkins Caulfield and Byers, has invested over US\$ 8 million in CoreOS. The company was also backed by Sequoia Capital and Fuel Capital in the past.



Mozilla to launch Firefox-based streaming Dongle, Netcast



After the successful launch of Google's Chromecast, which sold in millions, everyone else has discovered the potential of streaming devices. Recently, Amazon and Roku launched their devices. According to GigaOM, Mozilla will soon enter the market with its Firefox-powered streaming device. A Mozilla enthusiast, Christian Heilmann, recently

uploaded a photo of Mozilla's prototype streaming device on Twitter.

People at GigaOM managed to dig out more on it and even got their hands on the prototype as soon as that leaked photo went viral on Twitter. The device provides better functionality and options than Chromecast. Mozilla has partnered with some as yet unknown manufacturer to build this device. The prototype has been sent to some developers for testing and reviews. This device, which is called Netcast, has a hackable open bootloader, which makes it run some Chromecast apps.

Mozilla has always looked for an open environment for its products. It is expected

Linux Foundation releases Automotive Grade Linux to power cars

The Linux Foundation recently released Automotive Grade Linux (AGL) to power automobiles, a move that marks its first steps into the automotive industry. The Linux Foundation is sponsoring the AGL project to collaborate with the automotive, computing hardware and communications industries, apart from academia and other sectors. The first release of this system is available for free on the Internet. A Linux-based platform called Tizen IVI is used to power AGL. Tizen IVI was primarily designed for a broad range of devices—from smartphones and TVs to cars and laptops.

Here is the list of features that you can experience in the first release of AGL: a dashboard, Bluetooth calling, Google Maps, HVAC, audio controls, Smartphone Link Integration, media playback, home screen and news reader. The Linux Foundation and its partners are expecting this project to change the future of open source software. They hope to see next-generation car entertainment, navigation and other tools to be powered by open source software. The Linux Foundation expects collaborators to add new features and capabilities in future releases. Development of AGL is expected to continue steadily.

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